
Technical and Business Writing

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What is Resume?



A resume, or résumé, is a concise document typically not longer than one page.



The goal of a resume is to make an individual **stand out** from the competition.



Resumes are job specific that should be tailored for each position, skills and interest a job seeker applies to.



It benefits the applicant to adjust their resume for each job they apply to, ensuring it aligns with the specific requirements of the position.

Why Your Resume Matters?

First Impressions Count

Recruiters spend mere seconds scanning your resume. A strong first impression is vital to capture their attention immediately.

Gateway to Interviews

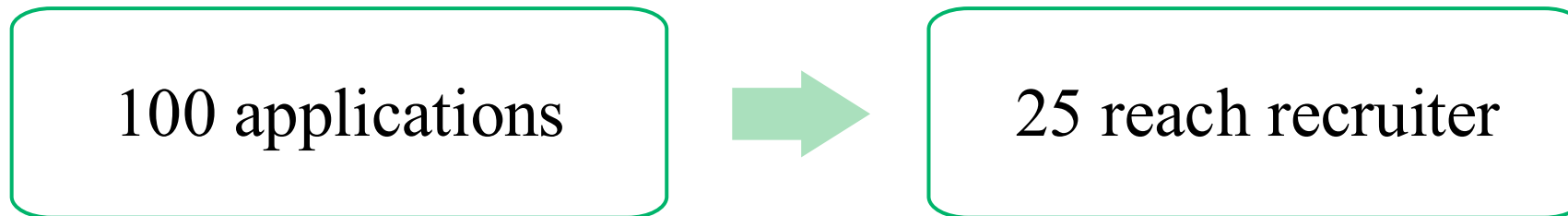
A compelling resume is your direct ticket to securing those all-important interviews in an increasingly crowded job market.

ATS Optimisation

Applicant Tracking Systems (ATS) now filter over 75% of resumes before they ever reach human eyes. Optimising for ATS is non-negotiable.

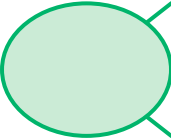


- 75% of resumes never reach a human recruiter.
- Most companies use **ATS software**.
- Your resume must pass the system first.

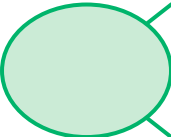


This is why formatting and keywords matter more than decoration.

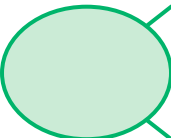
What Is an Applicant Tracking System (ATS)?



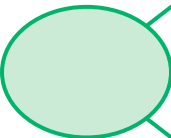
Collects resumes



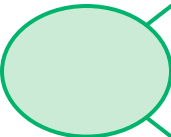
Scans content



Searches for keywords



Ranks applicants



Filters candidates

How ATS Scans Your Resume?

Job titles

Skills

Certifications

Education

Industry keywords

Python ✓

Machine Learning ✓

Team player ✗ (if not
in job ad)

What to Include: The Essential Sections

Contact Information

Your full name, professional email address, phone number, city, and hyperlinked LinkedIn profile.

Resume Heading

One-line job title (e.g., 'Junior Software Developer')

Professional Summary

A concise 2-3 sentence overview highlighting your most relevant skills and significant career achievements.

Work Experience

List roles in reverse chronological order, emphasising quantifiable achievements with specific metrics and results.

What to Include: The Essential Sections

Education

Detail your most recent and relevant academic degrees, certifications, and vocational training.

Skills

A tailored list of both hard and soft skills that are directly relevant to the specific job you are applying for.

Writing an effective objective for your resume

What is it?

- A 1-2 sentence statement at the top of your resume that tell the employer:

Who you
are

- Student/professional
- Major
- Year level/experience

What you
are seeking

- Internship
- Part-time job
- Full-time job

What skills
or value you
bring

Remember:

- ✓ Keep it short.
- ✓ Mention the specific role.
- ✓ Highlight relevant skills.
- ✓ Show what you can contribute, not just what you want.

What skills do employers want?

Activity

Look at the job ad and identify any word(s) or phrase(s) that look like skills.

What did you find?

- Technical skills
- Software/tools
- Languages
- Behaviour (e.g., teamwork, time management)
- Attitudes (e.g., self-motivated . . .)

Sort the skills

What can you do? How you work?

Three Types of Resume

Resume type	Description	When to use	Key sections
<u>Chronological</u>	Emphasizes your career path	When you're applying for jobs via an applicant tracking system (ATS) or showing career growth	Work experience, education , certifications
<u>Functional</u>	Emphasizes your skills	When you are changing careers and applying directly through a recruiter or hiring manager	Skills, brief work history, education, certification
<u>Combination</u> (Hybrid)	Combined emphasis on career path and skills	When it is important to show skills as well as <u>career progression</u>	Skills, work experience, education, certifications

Tailoring Your Resume: Keywords & Customisation

Craft Targeted Job Descriptions

Integrate Relevant Keywords

Improve ATS Ranking & Fit

Customise Resume Content



To maximise your resume's effectiveness, treat each application uniquely. Customising your resume shows employers you understand their needs and are genuinely interested in the role.

What to Leave Off Your Resume?

No Salary Information

Do not include past salary history or future salary expectations. This can be discussed later in the process.

Personal Details

Omit age, gender, marital status, and photos to avoid unconscious bias.

"References Available"

Remove the phrase "References available upon request." Recruiters will ask if needed.

Outdated Items

Exclude outdated certifications, full home addresses, and graphical elements like skill rating bars that confuse ATS.

